"FITNESS. FUN. FAMILY."

An Online Approach to Engaging the Family in Healthy Behaviors

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Theoretical Framework

Childhood Overweight and Obesity: Rates and Consequences

- The World Health Organization (WHO) defines a child as overweight if body mass index (BMI) is equal or greater than 85% of children the same age and sex. Furthermore, a child may be categorized as obese if BMI is equal or greater than 95% of children the same age and sex.[1]
- The Center for Disease Control (CDC) reports that 17% of American youth, ages 2-19, are categorized as obese. Currently, over 12.5 million youth in the United States fall into this category.[2]
- The consequences from childhood obesity may be physical, psychological, and emotional. A child with obesity may suffer increased risk for cardiovascular disease, diabetes, cancer and an increased adult mortality rate. [3] Research indicates that children with obesity are socially isolated, report feelings of insecurity, and possess low confidence and emotional well-being levels. [4]

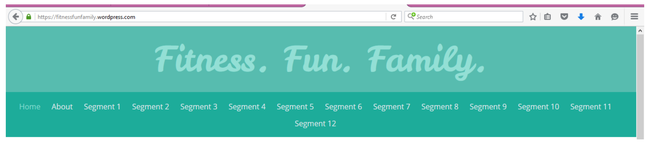
Expectancy-Value Theory: A Parent's Role in Modeling Healthy Behavioral Choices for Children

- Parents play a vital role in a child's health and well-being status. Role-modeling healthy behaviors demonstrates to children that these behaviors are highly valued. When a parent places high value on a specific task, a child is influenced by this and often places a high value on this task. Subsequently, a child expects to succeed at tasks which parents role-model self-competence in. This phenomenon is known as the **Expectancy-Value Theory.** [5]
- Studies indicate that parents who actively show concern about their child's health are more likely to limit sedentary television-watching time, take steps to improve child's nutrition and increase child's physical activity time. [6]
- Studies indicate a child's moderate to vigorous physical activity participation is directly related to a parent's/caregiver's belief that the child is competent in this task. [7]

Self-Efficacy Theory: A Parent's Role in Increasing a Child's Confidence in Healthy Behavioral Choices

- Self-efficacy is a person's belief in their ability to succeed in a particular situation. These beliefs impact how people think, behave, and feel. Self-efficacy develops across the span of a life-time, and childhood experiences are vital in the development of a strong sense of self-efficacy.
- Several sources which increase self-efficacy include:
    - *Mastery experiences*: Performing a task successfully (i.e. a parent teaching a child the rules of kickball and having that child play a successful game of kickball with them)
    - *Social modeling*: Witnessing others successfully complete a task (i.e. a parent taking the whole family along to cheer for them at a 5K run in race may increase the child's self-efficacy in running)
    - *Social persuasion*: Verbal encouragement from others (i.e. a parent verbally encouraging a child when grocery shopping together in their ability to pick out healthy and nutritional snacks)
    - *Psychological responses*: Mood or perceived stress levels concerning a certain situation (i.e. if a child expresses fear or stress concerning a healthy behavior choice, a parent may minimize this perceived stress to increase self-efficacy in the task) [8]
- Ultimately, a child's self-efficacy is ever changing and evolving. A parent can aid in increasing self-efficacy in healthy behavioral choices.

Teaching Family-Centered Healthy Cognitions and Behaviors Online

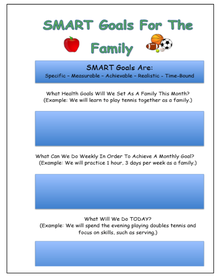


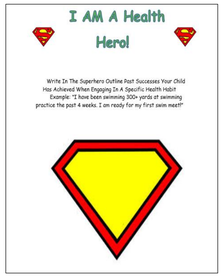
An Online Approach: Engaging the Family in Healthy Behaviors

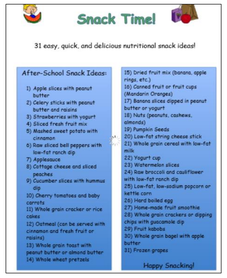
- Based upon theoretical framework:
    - Through role-modeling, a parent's behaviors and beliefs concerning health may directly influence a child's behavioral choices. [5]
    - A parent has the ability to increase a child's self-efficacy in healthy behaviors by providing 1) opportunities for their child to perform a healthy task successfully, 2) by role-modeling healthy behaviors, 3) by giving verbal encouragement and praise, and 4) by minimizing the child's perceived stress level when engaging in new The consequences from childhood obesity may be physical, psychological, and emotional. [8]
- An online program was created to assist parents in **role modeling** healthy behaviors to children. The program was intended to engage the entire family in healthful behaviors, and **to increase a child's self-efficacy** in their ability to make healthy behavioral choices in the future. An online format was chosen to allow a parent or caregiver to access the program information and lesson plans in an easy, and cost-effective manner.

Fitness. Fun. Family: A Way to Educate, Engage, and Energize the Family

- What is the Fitness. Fun. Family. Program?
    - The Fitness. Fun. Family. program is a 12 segment guide for parents and children who wish to enhance their skills in engaging in healthy behavioral choices together. Each part of the program introduces a skill which will aid in this process through worksheets, activities, and engaging videos which the parent and child utilize together. The program may be completed at a pace which is comfortable for the parent/child.
    - Several lessons taught include: SMART goal-setting as a family, positive affirmations and self-talk regarding healthy behaviors, nutritional and physical activity recommendations, and so forth.
    - Examples of lessons provided online below:







12 Segment Lessons and Skills

The 12 Segment Online Program: An Overview of Lessons and Skills

- Segment 1: Goals Are Fun!
    - Goal setting as a family, SMART goals
- Segment 2: Erasing Bad Habits
    - Identify bad habits, how to fight bad habits, weekly journal
- Segment 3: Let's Make Good Habits!
    - How to create healthy habits, what's your "why?" - family motivational factors, weekly journal activity
- Segment 4: The Power of Positivity
    - Eliminating negative self-talk, positive affirmations
- Segment 5: Embrace the Possibilities!
    - Possibility thinking, dream sheet
- Segment 6: You Are a Superhero!
    - Self efficacy in healthy behavior choices
- Segment 7: Let's Learn About Nutrition!
    - Healthy eating for the family, nutritional resources – Choose My Plate
- Segment 8: Let's Cook Together!
    - 31 nutritional recipes, weekly food journal
- Segment 9: Let's Learn About Exercise!
    - Physical activity recommendations/resources for the family
- Segment 10: Let's Get Active Together!
    - 31 ideas to get moving, physical activity journal
- Segment 11: Focus on Success
    - Celebrate success in program
- Segment 12: A New You!
    - Revisit family accomplishments and goals

Please Visit:

fitnessfunfamily.wordpress.com

For Further Information

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